CHAPTER 3

FORMATTING WITH PARAGRAPH STYLES

In this chapter, you'll learn about

- Using Paragraph Styles to Format a Document
- Selecting Paragraph Styles
- Preparing a List with a Hanging Indent
- Viewing Style Settings
- Previewing a Document

Formatting determines how a document will look when it's printed. The easiest way to format a document in WordStar is to use paragraph styles.

In this chapter, you'll learn how to use the paragraph styles that come with WordStar. After you format and edit a document, you'll preview the printed file.

USING PARAGRAPH STYLES

A paragraph style stores layout settings such as margins, tabs, line spacing, and font changes. When you select a paragraph style, all the text settings contained in that style are inserted into your document.

SELECTING THE TITLE STYLE

All WordStar documents use the Body Text style until you specify another style. The Body Text style contains the default WordStar settings for margins, tabs, line height, and so on. Body Text sets a left margin of 0 inches and a right margin of 6.5 inches, and starts the first line at the left margin.

In the following steps, you'll choose another style to change the look of a memo.

1. Open the file LIST.DOC.

   If you need help, see "Opening an Existing File" in the "Learning the Basics" chapter.

   You'll use the Title paragraph style to center the word "MEMO," make it bold, and give it a larger font.

2. With the cursor on the first letter of "MEMO," choose Style→Select Paragraph Style (Alt+S,S).

3. When the list of styles appears, select the Title style. You can either type **Title** or move the highlighting to Title. Press F10 or choose OK. If you have a mouse you can double-click Title.

The Title style command tag is inserted at the cursor location. The style bar shows that Title is the current paragraph style. The text is now bold, centered, and prints in a larger font.

SELECTING BODY TEXT

You want the text after "MEMO" to return to the default Body Text settings.

1. Move the cursor to the beginning of the line below "MEMO."

2 Choose Style→Select Paragraph Style (Alt+S,S) to select a paragraph style.

TIP If you have a mouse, you can click on the style name in the style bar to select a new paragraph style.

3 When the list of styles appears, select the Body Text style. You can type **Body Text** or move the highlighting to Body Text. Press F10 or choose OK. If you have a mouse, you can double-click Body Text.

The text following the Body Text command tag is no longer highlighted because bold is turned off. The original text settings are now in effect.

PREPARING A LIST WITH HANGING INDENT 1

To practice using the Hanging Indent 1 paragraph style, you'll prepare a list of props for the "Merry Wives of Windsor." The Hanging Indent 1 style formats text for a numbered list. The numbers are typed at a left margin of 0 inches and the text wraps at a left margin of .5 inch.

1 Move the cursor one line below the sentence that begins "Please prepare the props..."

2 Choose Style→Select Paragraph Style (Alt+S,S).

3 When the list of styles appears, select Hanging Indent 1. Press F10 or choose OK. The Hanging Indent 1 command tag is inserted into the text area.

4 Press Enter to move the cursor down one line.

5 Type **1.** and press the Tab key. The number is typed at the left margin of 0 inches. The Tab key indents the cursor to .5 inch.

6 Type the following text:

```
Small rustic table and three rustic chairs to be placed on
a slightly raised platform stage right.  The scene is set
on the street outside the tavern.
```

The text wraps to a .5 inch left margin.

7 Press Enter twice. Type **2.** and press the Tab key.

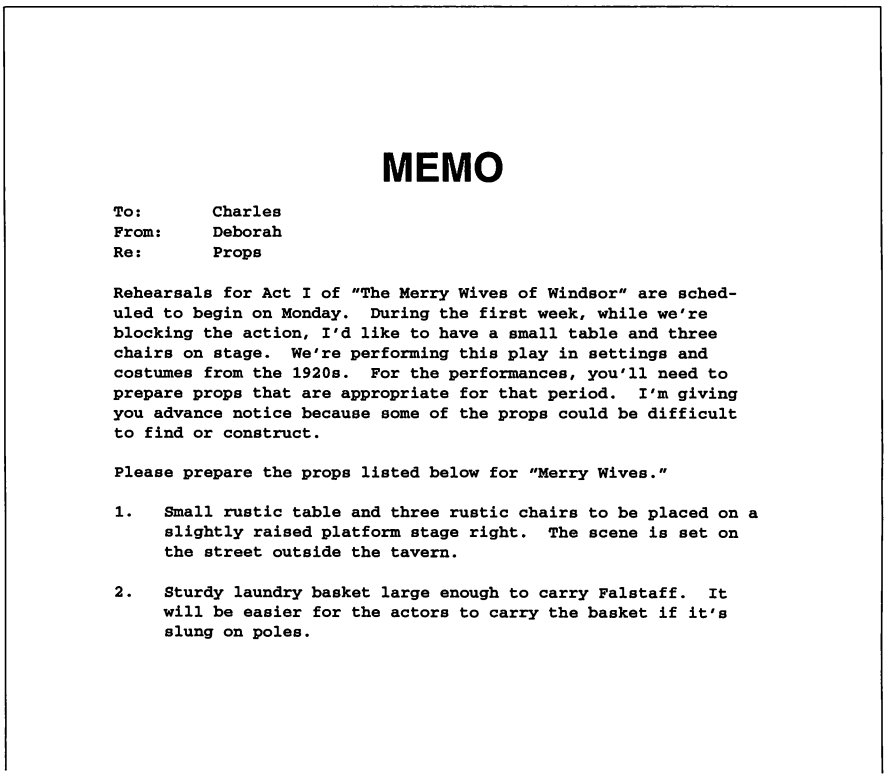
8 Type the following text:

```
Sturdy laundry basket large enough to carry Falstaff.  It
will be easier for the actors to carry the basket if it's
slung on poles.
```

In the list, the numbers are typed at the 0-inch first line indent. When the text wraps, it wraps at the .5 inch margin.

Note: Two other styles, Hanging Indent 2 and Hanging Indent 3, format text in a similar way. Hanging Indent 2 formats the first line of a paragraph at .5 inch and subsequent lines at 1 inch. Hanging Indent 3 indents at 1 inch and 1.5 inches.

This is how your document will look when you print it.



MEMO

To: Charles
From: Deborah
Re: Props

Rehearsals for Act I of "The Merry Wives of Windsor" are scheduled to begin on Monday. During the first week, while we're blocking the action, I'd like to have a small table and three chairs on stage. We're performing this play in settings and costumes from the 1920s. For the performances, you'll need to prepare props that are appropriate for that period. I'm giving you advance notice because some of the props could be difficult to find or construct.

Please prepare the props listed below for "Merry Wives."

1. Small rustic table and three rustic chairs to be placed on a slightly raised platform stage right. The scene is set on the street outside the tavern.

2. Sturdy laundry basket large enough to carry Falstaff. It will be easier for the actors to carry the basket if it's slung on poles.

VIEWING STYLE SETTINGS

You can look at the settings of any style.

1. Move the cursor to the line below the Hanging Indent 1 style command tag.

2. Choose Style→Define Paragraph Style (Alt+S,D) to view the settings of a paragraph style.

   You see the settings for the style currently in effect, which is Hanging Indent 1. Notice that the left margin is set at .5 inch and the first line indent (first line of each paragraph) is set at 0 inches.

3. Press Esc to close the Define Paragraph Style dialog box.

4. Move the cursor so that it immediately follows the Body Text command tag.

5. Repeat step 2 to choose Define Paragraph Style.

   The WordStar default settings are in effect. For example, bold is off, centering is off, and the default font is used.

6. Press Esc to close the dialog box.

7. Move the cursor to immediately follow the Title style tag. Repeat step 2 to view the style settings. The Title style is centered and bold. Also, if you have a large font, it will be used.

8. Press Esc to close the dialog box.

PREVIEWING A DOCUMENT

You can see how the printed list will look by using the Preview command.

1. Choose View→Preview (Alt+V,P) to choose Preview.

   TIP *You can also use* Alt+1 *to choose Preview.*

   A preview of the printed page appears. The title is bold, centered, and in a larger font. The numbered list is indented.

2. Choose View→2 to magnify the page to twice its size.

3. Use the direction keys to move the view to other parts of the page.

4. Try some of the other commands in Preview.

5. When you're finished, choose Exit→Original page to exit Preview and return to the page where you started Preview.

   TIP *Preview is useful if you have a long document. You can preview several pages and return to your original cursor location. You can also press Esc to return to the original page. In Preview, if you choose Exit→Current page, you return to edit the page that you're currently previewing.*

Follow the steps below to close the file.

1. Choose File→Close (Alt+F,C) to close the file without saving it.

2. In the Close File dialog box, press A to select Abandon.

   The file is closed without saving the changes and you're returned to the Opening screen.

The next chapter, "Editing Paragraph Styles," contains information about creating and editing paragraph styles.